

PILOT

ALSO: Biker, Mecha Pilot, Sky Pirate

*Within this steel beats
the hearts and hopes of all
of Minerva IV. The Empire
has already lost, they
just don't know it yet.*



Be they boastful racers, trained soldiers or elegant chaffeurs, **Pilots** develop a special bond with their vehicle – in a way, it becomes an extension of their body, which they can rely on for battle and travel.

While transports of all sorts are frequently seen in every **Fabula Ultima** world, a Pilot's vehicle is something unique and irreplaceable: it could be the very mecha their mother piloted in battle, a jury-rigged aviobike that shouldn't even be able to fly, or some sort of technological marvel.

- ♦ Where did you learn to pilot? Is your teacher still alive?
- ♦ How did you obtain your vehicle? Did you build it yourself? Did you inherit it?
- ♦ What personal touch makes your vehicle stand out from the rest?
- ♦ Who or what would you never allow aboard your vehicle?



PILOT FREE BENEFITS

- ♦ Permanently increase your maximum Hit Points by 5.
- ♦ Gain the ability to equip **martial melee weapons** and **martial ranged weapons**.

PILOT SKILLS

COMPRESSION TECH

As long as there is no one aboard your **personal vehicle**, you may have it safely disappear from the game world at any time. What magic or technology allows it?

If your **personal vehicle** is not present in the game world and you are in a space big enough to contain it, you may perform the **Inventory** action and spend 2 Inventory Points to have the vehicle appear near you, and **enter** it for free.

FLEXIBLE CONFIGURATION

[+4]

When you perform the **Equipment** or **Guard** action while driving your **personal vehicle**, you may choose up to **[SL]** of its enabled modules and **disable** them. If you do, choose up to **[SL]** among its disabled modules and **enable** them.

HEART IN THE ENGINE

[+3]

At the start of your turn during a conflict, if you are driving your **personal vehicle**, you may spend 10 Mind Points. If you do, choose one option: the next time you deal damage during this turn, deal **[SL × 2]** extra damage; **or**, the next time you suffer damage before the start of your next turn, that damage is reduced by **[SL × 2]** (applied **before** damage Affinities); **or**, you recover from either **slow** or **weak** (your choice).

PERSONAL VEHICLE

[+5]

When you acquire this Skill, you gain a **personal vehicle** with a **frame** of your choice and **three different modules** of your choice (see next page).

Whenever you acquire this Skill again, you acquire **two additional modules** of your choice.

STRONG GRIP

When you perform an Accuracy Check with a **weapon module**, you may replace **one** of the Attributes with **Might** (such as **[MIG + WLP]** for an **arcane module**).

A PILOT'S VEHICLE

A Pilot's **personal vehicle** follows a set of special rules.

- ♦ **Entering** the **personal vehicle** during a conflict requires the **Objective** action. Normally there is no Check required, but the Game Master may introduce a **Clock** if there are serious dangers or obstacles. If the **personal vehicle** is accessible when the conflict begins, characters may **enter it immediately** before the Initiative Check (**Core Rulebook**, page 59).
- ♦ **Leaving** the **personal vehicle** doesn't require an action, but during a conflict it can only be done on your turn, and only while no other effect is being resolved.
- ♦ The **personal vehicle** can contain a variable number of human-sized creatures depending on its **frame** and **modules**, but **only its Pilot may drive it**. Additionally, the other passengers **cannot cover creatures** when they perform the **Guard** action.
- ♦ The **maximum number of modules enabled at the same time** on a **personal vehicle** is equal to **[3 + its Pilot's Skill Level in Personal Vehicle]**. The Pilot may freely reassign their personal vehicle's enabled and disabled modules outside conflicts; this maximum limit always has priority on any other effect (such as when you enable modules via **Flexible Configuration**, for instance).

A **personal vehicle** is made of the following elements:

- ♦ A **frame** that informs its general shape: **Steed** for riding animals, bikes, small starfighters, skateboards and the likes; **Exoskeleton** for power armor and mechanical limbs; **Mecha** for large combat robots piloted from within. Each Pilot must pick the **frame** for their **personal vehicle** when they obtain the Skill. This remains unchanged for the rest of the game, so make sure to choose carefully based on your character's style and personality, and consider the role they will have in the campaign. For instance, choosing a fighter plane doesn't make much sense if your story takes place in the slums of a cyberpunk megalopolis (how about an anti-gravity bike instead?).
- ♦ A variable number of **weapon modules**, **armor modules**, and **support modules** that can be connected to the **personal vehicle**'s control systems (enabled) or kept inactive but still attached to the frame (disabled). Some options, such as the **Flexible Configuration** Skill and the **Secondary Offensive module**, may allow you to quickly enable and disable modules, or to briefly activate a disabled module.

The upcoming pages contain a detailed explanation of the various module types and the rules governing them, followed by lists of standard **frames** and **modules**.

ARMOR MODULES

While driving a **personal vehicle** with an **armor module** enabled, a Pilot does not have access to the normal contents of their **armor slot**. Instead, that slot is considered occupied by the **personal vehicle's armor module**. If the **personal vehicle** has no armor module enabled, the Pilot can keep using their equipped armor as normal.

- ♦ As soon as the Pilot stops driving a **personal vehicle** with an enabled **armor module**, they immediately regain access to their normal equipped armor.
- ♦ Armor modules marked with ♦ are considered to be **martial** armor for the sake of Skills and other effects, and they set the Pilot's Defense and Magic Defense to **fixed scores** (bonuses from shields and other effects still apply). Note that a Pilot can still equip these modules **even if they normally lack the ability** to equip martial armor.

For instance, a Pilot with the **Guardian** Class benefits from the **Defensive Mastery** Skill while driving a **personal vehicle** with a **Heavy Plating module** enabled, but they do not benefit from the **Dodge** Skill granted by the **Rogue** Class.

WEAPON MODULES

While driving a **personal vehicle** with one or more **weapon modules** enabled, a Pilot does not have access to the normal contents of their **hand slots**. Instead, those slots are considered occupied by the **personal vehicle's weapon modules**. If the **personal vehicle** has no weapon modules enabled, the Pilot can keep using their equipped weapons and shields as normal.

- ♦ As soon as the Pilot stops driving a **personal vehicle** with **weapon modules** enabled, they immediately regain access to all normal equipped weapons and shields.
- ♦ Each weapon module counts as a **one-handed, non-martial weapon** for the sake of character Skills and effects (with the exception of the **Shield module**, which is treated as a shield). When you set up your **personal vehicle's** weapon modules, declare which module will occupy your **main hand slot** and which will occupy your **off-hand slot**.
- ♦ Some weapon modules are cumbersome and prevent you from having other weapon modules (including **Shield modules!**) enabled on the same **personal vehicle**.

For instance, an **Axe module** can be used with the **Counterattack** Skill, and a **Rifle module** can be used with the **Crossfire** Skill (**Core Rulebook**, pages 219 and 205).

Because each weapon module is treated as a one-handed weapon, a Pilot driving a **personal vehicle** with two enabled weapon modules that share the same Category benefits from the rules for **two-weapon fighting** – and if they have the **Ambidexterous** Heroic Skill (**Core Rulebook**, page 234), this can be done with any two enabled weapon modules!

SUPPORT MODULES

Support modules provide a variety of miscellaneous benefits; these benefits often apply to the vehicle's passengers in addition to the Pilot themselves.

- ♦ A **personal vehicle** cannot have **more than one enabled support module of the same name**.
- ♦ Some support modules are particularly complex or cumbersome and count as **two modules** towards the limit on total enabled modules.

DAMAGE AND REPAIRS

A Pilot's **personal vehicle** doesn't have its own separate stats and is treated as an extension of the Pilot themselves. It can be damaged or rendered temporarily unusable as a narrative consequence of the Pilot's **Surrender**, but cannot be destroyed unless the Player agrees to it.

Repairing a narratively damaged **personal vehicle** requires an amount of zenit equal to **[its Pilot's SL in Personal Vehicle, multiplied by 100]**. On the other hand, rebuilding a destroyed **personal vehicle** should be achieved as part of the Pilot's narrative arc (which is why it should only be destroyed if the Player is okay with it).



RARE MODULES AS REWARDS

The Game Master should include new modules (or upgraded versions of existing modules) for the Pilot among the campaign's rewards.

- ♦ Each **weapon and armor module** presented in the following pages has a base cost of 500 zenit, and their rare versions can be created using the rules for **rare items** found in the **Core Rulebook**, starting on page 266. There are, however, two exceptions: a weapon module's damage can only be increased by 4 points by raising its cost by 200 zenit (it can **never** become two-handed), and **a weapon module can never become martial** (not even if its damage formula becomes **[HR + 10]** or higher).
- ♦ Each **support module** presented in the following pages should have a cost of roughly 1000 zenit. If you create custom support modules, compare them with the existing ones in order to establish their cost in zenit. They are **rare** items.
- ♦ The special rules used for some weapon modules (such as the **Claymore module**, which prevents you from having other weapon modules enabled, or the **Shield module's** entire effect) **are not Qualities**, and thus cannot be lost or replaced. If a given module has a Quality, that Quality is listed **before** any of its special rules.
- ♦ A Pilot might acquire rare modules by purchasing them from dedicated shops, by exploring factories or laboratories, or as a reward after defeating robotic or artificial adversaries. You can find some sample rare weapon modules on page 86.

And finally, as a general rule, a Pilot should **never** have access to two or more support modules with different names whose effects are similar and/or cumulative.

INTERACTIONS WITH THE TINKERER CLASS

A character with the **Tinkerer** Class might wish to use the **Upgrade** Heroic Skill and the rules for **Projects** (**Core Rulebook**, pages 241 and 134) to improve modules or invent new customizations for a Pilot's **personal vehicle**. For instance, they might install a reactor to enable space flight, or an antenna that emits anti-magic waves.

When it comes to special modules created through Projects, the group as a whole should make sure these **do not impede** on other characters' strengths and roles. It can be a good idea to give such modules a limited number of uses, or interesting flaws that can lead to difficult choices and memorable scenes.

SAMPLE PERSONAL VEHICLES

The rules for **personal vehicles** offer a slew of choices and options, but this can also lead to indecisiveness. The following list of ready-made vehicles can help guide your choices – customize them as you wish.

HOVERSKATE

Steed; Personal Vehicle: 1 SL

Enabled modules: **Aerial, Claymore, Rapid Interface**

ARMORED MOTORCYCLE

Steed; Personal Vehicle: 2 SL

Enabled modules: **Expanded Plating, Heavy Plating, Machine Gun, Seat, Turbo**

ASSAULT EXOSKELETON

Exoskeleton; Personal Vehicle: 3 SL

Enabled modules: **Advanced Targeting, Counterstrike, Heavy Plating, Rifle, Sensor, Shield**; disabled modules: **Aerial**

BIPEDAL DESTROYER

Mecha; Personal Vehicle: 2 SL

Enabled modules: **Axe, Flamer, Secondary Offensive (Cannon), Standard Plating**; disabled modules: **Cannon**

INFILTRATOR SCOUT

Mecha; Personal Vehicle: 2 SL

Enabled modules: **Anti-Element, Rifle, Runic Plating, Sensor, Spear**

MECHANICAL CRAB

Mecha; Personal Vehicle: 2 SL

Enabled modules: **Claw ×2, Heavy Plating, Power, Seafarer**

SCORPION-CLASS ARMORSUIT

Exoskeleton; Personal Vehicle: 2 SL

Enabled modules: **Blade ×2, Flexible Plating, Secondary Offensive (Scythe)**; disabled modules: **Scythe**

STARFIGHTER

Steed; Personal Vehicle: 2 SL

Enabled modules: **Advanced Targeting, Aerial, Machine Gun, Standard Plating**; disabled modules: **Cannon**

FRAMES

FRAME	PASSENGERS	DISTANCE
Exoskeleton	None	No modifier

This **personal vehicle** may have up to **2 weapon modules**, **1 armor module** and **any number of support modules** enabled.

If you use the **Compression Tech** Skill with this **personal vehicle**, ignore the IP cost.

Mecha	None	×2
--------------	------	----

This **personal vehicle** may have up to **2 weapon modules**, **1 armor module** and **any number of support modules** enabled.

Steed	Up to one	×2
--------------	-----------	----

This **personal vehicle** may have up to **1 weapon module**, **1 armor module** and **any number of support modules** enabled.

If you use the **Heart in the Engine** Skill with this **personal vehicle**, ignore the MP cost.

“Passengers” indicates how many human-sized creatures the **personal vehicle** may transport in addition to the Pilot. “Distance” refers to the distance traveled during a **travel day**.

ARMOR MODULES

ARMOR MODULE	DEFENSE	MAGIC DEFENSE
Flexible Plating	DEX size +2	INS size +1
Heavy Plating ♦	12	8
Runic Plating ♦	10	11
Standard Plating ♦	11	10

These benefits **only apply to the Pilot who is driving**. However, the scores granted by the **Heavy**, **Runic**, and **Standard Plating modules** can be extended to passengers through the **Expanded Plating module** (page 168).

WEAPON MODULES

WEAPON MODULES	ACCURACY	DAMAGE
 Arcane Arcane ♦ Melee ♦ No Qualities.	[DEX + WLP]	[HR + 8] physical
 Axe Heavy ♦ Melee ♦ No Qualities.	[DEX + INS]	[HR + 12] physical
 Blade Dagger ♦ Melee ♦ No Qualities.	[DEX + INS] +1	[HR + 6] physical
 Bow Bow ♦ Ranged ♦ No Qualities. ♦ A personal vehicle with this module enabled cannot have any other weapon modules enabled.	[DEX + INS] +1	[HR + 12] physical
 Cannon Firearm ♦ Ranged ♦ No Qualities. ♦ A personal vehicle with this module enabled cannot have any other weapon modules enabled.	[DEX + INS]	[HR + 14] physical
 Claw Brawling ♦ Melee ♦ No Qualities. ♦ This weapon can be used to interact with the scene as if it were a free hand.	[DEX + INS]	[HR + 8] physical
 Claymore Sword ♦ Melee ♦ No Qualities. ♦ A personal vehicle with this module enabled cannot have any other weapon modules enabled.	[DEX + INS] +1	[HR + 14] physical
 Esoteric Arcane ♦ Melee ♦ No Qualities. ♦ A personal vehicle with this module enabled cannot have any other weapon modules enabled.	[DEX + WLP]	[HR + 12] physical
 Flail Flail ♦ Melee ♦ No Qualities.	[DEX + INS]	[HR + 10] physical
 Flamer Firearm ♦ Ranged ♦ No Qualities.	[DEX + INS]	[HR + 8] fire

⚠ The special rules found on weapon modules **are not Qualities** (page 163)!

WEAPON MODULES		ACCURACY	DAMAGE
	Machine Gun Firearm ♦ Ranged ♦ No Qualities ♦ A personal vehicle with this module enabled cannot have any other weapon modules enabled. Additionally, when you perform the Attack action and attack with this weapon module, you may perform two separate attacks instead of one (against the same target or against different targets). If you do, both attacks follow the rules for two-weapon fighting : each attack loses the multi property and cannot gain it, and you treat the High Roll of each Accuracy Check as being equal to 0 when determining damage.	[DEX + INS]	[HR + 10] physical
	Rifle Firearm ♦ Ranged ♦ No Qualities.	[DEX + INS]	[HR + 10] physical
	Scythe Heavy ♦ Melee ♦ No Qualities. ♦ A personal vehicle with this module enabled cannot have any other weapon modules enabled.	[DEX + INS]	[HR + 16] physical
	Shield (Exoskeleton and Mecha frames only) No Qualities. ♦ While driving this personal vehicle , you gain a +2 bonus to Defense and a +2 bonus to Magic Defense. Additionally, this weapon module does not count as a “weapon”: instead, it counts as an equipped shield . This module cannot be equipped in your main hand slot , unless you have acquired the Dual Shieldbearer Skill (Core Rulebook , page 197). If you have, your Twin Shields deal 2 extra damage (this is cumulative if you have two Shield modules enabled at the same time).		
	Spear Spear ♦ Melee ♦ No Qualities.	[DEX + INS]	[HR + 10] physical
	Sword Sword ♦ Melee ♦ No Qualities.	[DEX + INS] +1	[HR + 8] physical
	Trident Spear ♦ Melee ♦ No Qualities. ♦ A personal vehicle with this module enabled cannot have any other weapon modules enabled.	[DEX + INS] +1	[HR + 14] physical

SUPPORT MODULES

SUPPORT MODULE

Aerial (counts as two enabled modules)

This **personal vehicle** can fly, and its **distance** becomes $\times 3$.

While you are driving this **personal vehicle**, your **melee** attacks can target **flying** creatures, and none of the creatures inside the **personal vehicle** can be targeted by **melee** attacks unless the attacker is flying or is somehow able to reach flying targets.

These benefits do not apply while the **personal vehicle** is inactive or grounded, while you are in **Crisis**, or while you are **covering** another creature with the **Guard** action. Additionally, if a creature aboard this **personal vehicle** suffers **air**, **bolt** or **ice** damage during a conflict, the benefits of this module cease until the start of your next turn.

Anti-Element

Each time you enable this module on your **personal vehicle**, choose a damage type: **air**, **bolt**, **earth**, **fire** or **ice**. Creatures aboard this **personal vehicle** are treated as being Resistant to the chosen damage type as long as this module remains enabled.

Advanced Targeting

While driving this **personal vehicle**, you gain a +2 bonus to your Accuracy Checks and to Magic Checks for offensive spells (⚡) you cast.

Counterstrike

After a creature aboard this **personal vehicle** is hit by a **ranged** attack, if you are driving this **vehicle**, you may spend 1 Inventory Point. If you do, you deal 10 **physical** damage to the attacker (after their attack has been resolved). This amount increases by 5 damage if you are **level 20 or higher**, or by 10 damage if you are **level 40 or higher**.

Excavation

This **personal vehicle** can burrow through the ground and is equipped with bright lights.

Expanded Plating (Mecha and Steed frames only)

While you are driving this **personal vehicle**, if it has a **Heavy**, **Runic**, or **Standard Plating module** enabled, all passengers aboard may treat their Defense and Magic Defense scores as being equal to those provided by the **armor module** in question (they may still use their normal scores if those are better).

SUPPORT MODULE

Magistatic

After you pay the MP cost of an **Arcanum**, **spell**, or **verse** (*High Fantasy Atlas*, page 138), if you are driving this **personal vehicle** and have an **arcane** weapon equipped, you recover 5 Mind Points, or 10 Mind Points if the cost was **equal to or higher than 30 MP**.

Power (Exoskeleton and Mecha frames only)

While driving this **personal vehicle**, you gain a +2 bonus to all Opposed Checks that rely on **brute force** or **physical resistance**.

Rapid Interface

When you **enter** this **personal vehicle** on your turn during a conflict, you may perform an additional action.

Seafarer

This **personal vehicle** can travel on water and underwater.

Seat (Mecha and Steed only)

This **personal vehicle** can transport an additional human-sized passenger.

Secondary Offensive (Exoskeleton and Mecha frames only)

Each time you enable this module on your **personal vehicle**, choose one of its **disabled weapon modules**. As long as the chosen module is **disabled** and this module is **enabled**, you may use an action to perform a **free attack** with that **weapon module**.

Sensor

While driving this **personal vehicle**, you gain a +2 bonus to Open Checks made to examine nearby creatures, items and locations.

Turbo

While driving this **personal vehicle**, you gain a +2 bonus to all Opposed Checks that rely on **speed** and **rapid maneuvers**.